



LOWER PAXTON TOWNSHIP

BOARD OF SUPERVISORS BUDGET WORKSHOP

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2024 - 5:30 PM, ROOM 174

1. CALL TO ORDER - Chair Lindsey
2. Pledge Of Allegiance
3. PRESENTATION OF 2025 FIRE FUND (FUND 20) BUDGET PROPOSAL (FIRE BUREAU)

Documents:

[DRAFT - FIRE BUDGET REPORT - 10-4-2024.PDF](#)

4. PRESENTATION OF 2025 GENERAL FUND BUDGET PROPOSAL (POLICE BUREAU)

Documents:

[DRAFT - POLICE BUDGET REPORT - 10-4-2024.PDF](#)

5. Adjourn

LOWER PAXTON TOWNSHIP
Proposed 2025 Budget
Fire Protection Tax and Equipment Fund

<u>Account Number</u>	<u>Account Title</u>	<u>2023 Actual</u>	<u>2024 Adopted Budget</u>	<u>2024 Projected Actual</u>	<u>2025 Proposed Budget</u>	<u>Notes/Remarks</u>
OPERATING REVENUES:						
20-3110-301.10	Taxes - Real Estate Current	\$ 2,117,136	\$ 2,128,807	\$ 2,134,340	\$ 4,169,059	Factored off interim assessed value (<i>certified roll expected in November 2025</i>) and historical collection rate for 0.6365 dedicated tax mills. Proposed increase to 1.240 dedicated tax mills for paid career staffing and related costs and maintain adequate financial reserves.
20-3110-301.30	Taxes - Real Estate Delinq/Refund	18,783	47,063	44,100	44,211	Allocated share of est. annual \$165,000 in delinquent collections and related penalty/interest by the County, net of 5% collection fees and allocable share of appeal refunds.
20-3110-341.01	Interest Earnings	62,329	48,000	48,500	60,000	Allocation of interest earnings (current rates at 5%), with declining investment balances as year progresses (4% estimate) for operating reserves.
TOTAL FIRE TAX FUND OPERATING REVENUES		2,198,247	2,223,870	2,226,940	4,273,270	
OPERATING EXPENDITURES:						
20-4110-411.110	Wages - Fire Management	104,583	140,624	148,632	153,826	Annual salary for Deputy Fire Chief position and allocated share of Public Safety Director; <i>wage index placeholder applied</i> .
20-4110-411.120	Wages - Full-Time Firefighters	-	-	-	242,667	<u>Partial-year salary</u> for eight new firefighters to complement volunteer fire company response.
20-4110-411.122	Wages - Full-Time Lieutenants	-	-	-	66,733	<u>Partial-year salary</u> for two new lieutenants to complement volunteer fire company response.
20-4110-411.130	Wages - Part-Time Assistant Chiefs	-	-	-	18,000	New part-time assistant chief to manage vehicle maintenance of Township-owned apparatus, and assist with the supervision of career staffing.
20-4110-411.170	Wages - Longevity	-	125	83	188	Annual payments to full-time administration staff, per years of service and corresponding agreements.
20-4110-411.300	Supp & Admin - Office Supplies	19,852	750	750	750	Unbudgeted costs in 2023 relative to furniture, turn-out gear, and onboarding supplies for the Deputy Fire Chief, and other administrative expenses; budget divided in more detail for 2024/onward.
20-4110-411.312	Supp & Admin - Printing	-	-	-	500	Business cards and associated print material costs.
20-4110-411.320	Supp & Admin - Employment Costs	-	-	250	20,000	Costs for applicant testing and medical/psychological testing for new career staffing.

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20-4110-411.322	Supp & Admin - Training/Seminars	249	4,000	4,000	5,000	Required and discretionary training and education for new career staffing and Deputy positions.
20-4110-411.324	Supp & Admin - Dues/Subscriptions	-	1,000	700	1,000	Professional organization and publications costs.
20-4110-411.326	Supp & Admin - Uniforms	-	3,000	3,000	18,000	Purchase of new career staff uniforms as well as various Bureau of Fire branded apparel.
20-4110-411.420	R&M - Vehicle Maintenance	471	1,000	1,000	2,000	Maintenance on two Township duty vehicles for fire service (one new)
20-4110-411.519	Prof Svcs - Fire/EMS Study	26,248	-	-	-	
20-4110-411.536	Prof Svcs - Snow Removal	-	-	9,600	9,600	Township-subsidized salt and anti-skid materials for the volunteer fire stations.
20-4110-411.542	Prof Svcs - IT Subscriptions/Licenses	235	20,000	17,750	31,000	Includes individual-specific subscriptions for new and existing Township employees and records management system as well as new application/onboarding, testing, and communications software and vehicle/apparatus dash cameras (11) and cloud storage platform.
20-4110-411.551	Prof Svcs - Volunteer Fire Allotments	552,139	553,200	553,200	529,000	0.15% historical tax collection rate (<i>prior year included \$9,000 per company for insurance allotment; now township insured</i>); paid in equal quarterly allotments to the respective volunteer companies.
20-4110-411.557	Prof Svcs - Volunteer Fire Stipends	49,400	525,600	505,000	689,850	Vehicle staffing stipend program implemented in November 2023 for volunteer fire companies for minimum vehicle and response manning, moved to round-the-clock program in mid-2024. <i>With proposed paid career staffing, assumption is 75% stipend coverage in 2025 budget.</i>
20-4110-411.600	Utilities - Vehicle Fuel	3,641	5,000	4,000	6,500	Estimated fuel on two Township duty vehicles for fire service (one new)
20-4110-411.634	Utilities - Water - Hydrants	260,265	260,500	264,000	277,500	Annual PUC-approved rent charges from Veolia for public hydrant network within Township; <i>PUC rate increase approval to occur during 2025, driving annual costs closer to \$300,000</i> .
20-4110-411.670	Utilities - Telephone	965	1,050	1,050	1,920	Cellular phone and mobile computing coverage subscriptions.
20-4110-411.900	Capital - Vehicle Purchases	8,445	-	-	-	
20-4110-411.910	Capital - Equipment Purchases	-	5,000	5,769	183,190	2024 includes Toughbook for Deputy. 2025 includes Toughbooks for Public Safety Director and Assistant Chief as well as turnout gear and portable radios for new career staff.
20-4700-471.820	Debt - Principal - 2019 Bonds	234,000	242,000	242,000	256,000	Annual principal debt service (through 2030) for prior apparatus purchase.
20-4700-472.820	Debt - Interest - 2019 Bonds	78,810	69,290	69,290	59,330	Relating interest debt service.
20-4810-481.200	Benefits & Taxes - Social Security/Medicare Taxes	8,001	10,767	11,377	36,828	Estimated employer taxes; additional benefits below.

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20-4810-483.220	Benefits & Taxes - Minimum Municipal Obligations (MMO)	16,653	24,354	21,506	18,258	Estimated employee benefits and taxes for full- and part-time positions noted/allocated above, including Workmens Compensation insurance for volunteer fire company members (State mandated).
20-4810-484.230	Benefits & Taxes - Workmens Compensation	55,734	72,782	72,883	84,714	
20-4810-487.240	Benefits & Taxes - Medical Insurance	31,441	36,416	36,416	42,955	
20-4810-487.242	Benefits & Taxes - Self-Insured Dental/Vision	1,620	2,313	3,000	2,313	
20-4810-487.250	Benefits & Taxes - Life Insurance	176	270	285	295	
20-4810-487.270	Benefits & Taxes - Self-Insured Short-Term Disability Insura	69	70	15	165	
20-4810-487.272	Benefits & Taxes - Long-Term Disability Insurance	211	388	314	317	
20-4820-486.730	Misc - Liability & Casualty Insurances	590	650	7,775	28,500	Estimated allocation of vehicle (<i>apparatus insured under the Township policy late 2024/onward</i>) and other general liability insurances.
20-4900-492.707	Misc - Transfer to Capital Reserve	304,500	305,410	305,410	305,410	Annual budgeted allotment transfer to capital reserves (below), as well as any sales proceeds or other dedicated transfers.
TOTAL FIRE TAX FUND OPERATING EXPENDITURES		1,758,297	2,285,559	2,289,055	3,092,309	
NET TOTAL FIRE TAX FUND CHANGE IN OPERATING RESERVES		439,950	(61,689)	(62,115)	1,180,961	
Net Financial Operating Reserves - Beginning		1,147,466	1,587,416	1,587,416	1,525,301	
NET FINANCIAL OPERATING RESERVES - ENDING		\$ 1,587,416	\$ 1,525,727	\$ 1,525,301	\$ 2,706,262	Proposed addition to reserves necessary for full-year career stipends and wage/benefit and inflationary pressures, and maintianing minimum financial reserves policy (25% of current revenues) in future years.

CAPITAL RESERVE REVENUES:						
20-3900-341.01	Interest Earnings - Capital Reserve	\$ 81,391	\$ 90,000	\$ 117,700	\$ 48,500	Allocation of interest earnings (current rates at 5%), declining for market and reserves reduction for apparatus prepayments below (4% estimate).
20-3900-392.50	Transfers In - Fire Operations	304,500	305,410	305,410	305,410	Annual budgeted allotment transfer from operations (above), as well as any sales proceeds and/or other dedicated transfers.
TOTAL FIRE TAX FUND CAPITAL RESERVE REVENUES		385,891	395,410	423,110	353,910	

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CAPITAL RESERVE EXPENDITURES:						
20-4900-411.420	R&M - Catastrophic Repairs - Capital Reserve	6,937	-	-	-	
20-4900-411.900	Capital - Vehicle Purchases - Capital Reserve	-	-	20,465	74,500	2024 includes upfit cost for replacement Deputy Fire Chief vehicle, rotated to Police due to totaled vehicle. 2025 includes new duty vehicle/upfit for proposed Assistant Fire Chief.
20-4900-411.904	Capital - Apparatus Purchases - Capital Reserve	-	-	3,067,864	-	2024 includes prepayment for three replacement apparatus for the volunteer stations (<i>likely 2-3 year build-out</i>).
TOTAL FIRE TAX FUND CAPITAL RESERVE EXPENDITURES		6,937	-	3,088,329	74,500	
NET TOTAL FIRE TAX FUND CHANGE IN CAPITAL RESERVES		378,954	395,410	(2,665,219)	279,410	
Net Financial Capital Reserves - Beginning		872,620	1,740,460	1,740,460	(924,759)	
NET FINANCIAL CAPITAL RESERVES - ENDING		\$ 1,251,574	\$ 2,135,870	\$ (924,759)	\$ (645,349)	Negative reserves anticipated to be temporary, based on pending apparatus sales.

<u>Change in Operating Revenues/Expenditures Statistics</u>	<u>2024 Budget vs. 2025 Budget</u>	<u>Percentage Change</u>	<u>2024 Projected vs. 2025 Budget</u>	<u>Percentage Change</u>
Increase (Decrease) in Operating Revenues	\$ 2,049,400	92.15%	\$ 2,046,330	91.89%
Increase (Decrease) in Operating Expenditures	\$ 806,750	35.30%	\$ 803,254	35.09%

<u>Contractual/Discretionary Expenditures Statistics</u>	<u>2025 Budget</u>	<u>2024 Budget vs. 2025 Budget</u>	<u>Percentage Change</u>	<u>2024 Projected vs. 2025 Budget</u>
Budget Operating Expenditures -- Contractual (Personnel)	\$ 481,414	\$ 340,665	242.04%	\$ 332,699
Budget Operating Expenditures -- Discretionary	\$ 2,610,895	\$ 466,085	21.73%	\$ 470,555

LOWER PAXTON TOWNSHIP

Proposed 2025 Budget

Police Department

Account Number	Account Title	2023 Actual	2024 Adopted Budget	2024 Projected Actual	2025 Proposed Budget	Notes/Remarks
EXPENDITURES:						
01-4100-410.110	Wages - Public Safety Director	\$ 147,325	\$ 109,871	\$ 109,871	\$ 113,724	Director of Public Safety full-time position; <i>wage index placeholder applied</i> .
01-4100-410.112	Wages - Logistics & Admin	127,909	117,853	88,254	109,221	Two civilian full-time positions; <i>wage index placeholder applied</i> .
01-4100-410.114	Wages - Full-Time Operational Support Agent	109,185	132,826	41,297	112,984	Wages relative to fully-funded State Police support agreement; <i>partially filled in 2024</i> .
01-4100-410.120	Wages - Full-Time Command Staff	406,771	407,139	407,056	421,304	Deputy Chief of Police, Captain, and Lieutenant full-time command positions; <i>wage index placeholder applied</i> .
01-4100-410.121	Wages - Full-Time Sergeants	468,622	455,522	531,275	471,413	Four Sergeants (Patrol, Special Operations, Criminal Investigation [CI] Unit, and Administrative) full-time positions under Police Union Collective Bargaining Agreement (CBA); contractual 3.5% increase applied.
01-4100-410.122	Wages - Full-Time Police Officers	4,259,620	4,349,199	4,180,236	4,537,019	50 full-time Patrol Officer positions under Police Union CBA, including four new positions in 2025 (partial-year hires) ; contractual 3.5% increase applied.
01-4100-410.123	Wages - Full-Time Corporals	893,499	755,062	768,062	794,416	Seven Corporals (Special Operations, CI Unit, Administrative, and four Patrol) full-time positions under Police Union CBA; contractual 3.5% increase applied.
01-4100-410.124	Wages - Full-Time Civilians	219,750	211,691	211,691	220,647	AFSCME Business Office Supervisor, Secretary, and two Clerk full-time positions; contractual 3% increase applied.
01-4100-410.125	Wages - Full-Time Community Service Officers	54,100	49,525	33,368	46,051	Community Service Officer full-time position; <i>wage index placeholder applied</i> .
01-4100-410.150	Wages - Shift Differential	31,897	32,000	31,200	32,000	Additional \$1/hour for all Union staffing from 6PM to 6AM
01-4100-410.160	Wages - Overtime	139,378	120,000	190,000	200,000	Budgeted at historic levels, <u>gross</u> of any reimbursement revenue, heightened for additional PTS grant opportunities and vacant position coverage (late 2024/early 2025).
01-4100-410.164	Wages - Outside Employment (Overtime)	36,208	25,000	25,000	27,500	Overtime labor related to subcontracting for area schools and business events public safety coverage.
01-4100-410.170	Wages - Longevity	330,216	374,147	348,370	362,181	Annual payments to administration and Union staff, per years of service and corresponding agreements.
01-4100-410.180	Wages - Accumulated Comp Time Payouts	18,731	20,000	19,113	20,000	Annual payment for unused Union compensatory time in the prior calendar year.
01-4100-410.182	Wages - Accumulated Leave Payouts	-	60,500	190,764	-	Voluntary termination payout for vacation, sick, and compensatory time; <i>four estimated for 2024</i> .
01-4100-410.300	Supp & Admin - Office Supplies	6,280	5,000	5,000	5,000	Allotment for general office operating supplies.
01-4100-410.306	Supp & Admin - IT Supplies	4,928	5,000	2,500	5,000	Includes minor computer replacement supplies.
01-4100-410.312	Supp & Admin - Printing	334	500	375	500	Pre-printed and custom forms and tickets.
01-4100-410.320	Supp & Admin - Employment Costs	14,094	8,500	10,000	20,000	Includes expenses for recruitment/promotion (<i>expansion proposed for 2025</i>), educational supplies, and accreditation costs.
01-4100-410.322	Supp & Admin - Training/Seminars	27,974	35,000	31,000	35,000	Discretionary and mandatory training for all levels of the department, including one-time \$4,000 for command school training (<i>pushed from 2024 to 2025</i>).
01-4100-410.324	Supp & Admin - Dues/Subscriptions	5,172	7,000	7,000	7,500	Annual memberships, including Hunters & Angles (for weapons training), and organization/publication memberships.
01-4100-410.326	Supp & Admin - Uniforms	32,747	28,500	28,500	91,000	Includes contract allowances as well as laundry and replacement services and new hires uniforms (\$1,500/each). 2025 includes proposed new Class A uniforms for each existing sworn officer (60; \$60,000).

LOWER PAXTON TOWNSHIP

Proposed 2025 Budget

Police Department

Account Number	Account Title	2023 Actual	2024 Adopted Budget	2024 Projected Actual	2025 Proposed Budget	Notes/Remarks
01-4100-410.330	Supp & Admin - Traffic/Safety Supplies	11,775	8,500	9,500	8,500	Includes forensic blood kits for alcohol/drug analysis, speed and traffic timer certifications and calibrations, and other related supplies.
01-4100-410.331	Supp & Admin - Criminal Investigation Supplies	8,786	9,500	9,500	9,500	Includes supplies for fingerprint/photo processing and crime lab protection and forensic materials.
01-4100-410.332	Supp & Admin - Patrol Supplies	13,496	6,000	6,000	6,000	Includes patrol vehicle and supply/equipment replacements.
01-4100-410.333	Supp & Admin - Body Armor	20,681	17,750	17,750	18,989	Purchase of new hires and replacement body armor (bullet-proof vests), with approx. 50% reimbursement in following year from Federal grant program.
01-4100-410.334	Supp & Admin - Canine Supplies	22,286	14,000	14,000	22,200	Cost associated with the four canine units; costs increased in 2025 for retirement and training replacement.
01-4100-410.335	Supp & Admin - Weapons	13,827	18,850	19,500	23,350	Annual purchases for ammunition, targets, and weapons purchases and maintenance, including four new hires purchases.
01-4100-410.336	Supp & Admin - Operational Support Agent	11,855	16,000	11,110	15,700	Non-wage costs (vehicle lease, equipment, utilities, etc.) relative to fully-funded State Police support agreement.
01-4100-410.420	R&M - Vehicle Maintenance	60,784	52,500	47,500	47,500	Costs for servicing vehicles and repairs from incidents (net of insurance reimbursements).
01-4100-410.542	Prof Svcs - IT Subscriptions/Licenses	83,084	86,500	87,500	185,500	Allocated share of Township user licenses/subscriptions, and department-specific licenses/subscriptions for records management, investigation/forensics, and camera recordings; <i>2025 includes two new software platforms (primarily grant funded), and first year of Watchguard dash/body camera cloud storage (\$75,705; previously grant funded) .</i>
01-4100-410.555	Prof Svcs - Victim's Witness Advocate/Co-Responder	50,083	40,002	57,000	148,417	Represents 25% cost share for County Victim Witness Advocate (\$15,000) and 50% cost share for County Co-Responder (\$42,408) positions; <i>Co-Responder matched with Federal grants in 2023 and 2024 . 2025 includes additional County Co-Responder (\$91,008), fully funded in 2025 and most of 2026 through Federal grant .</i>
01-4100-410.556	Prof Svcs - Crossing Guards	22,223	-	-	-	<i>Ceased; CDSD managing all staffing since mid-2023.</i>
01-4100-410.558	Prof Svcs - PTS Grant Allotments	11,456	192,858	75,353	133,307	Beginning October 2023, distribution of Federally-funded PTS awards to police programs in Dauphin County.
01-4100-410.570	Prof Svcs - Copier Maintenance Contracts	10,366	5,500	4,900	5,000	Includes annual copier leases, reducing through consolidated units/features and new provider.
01-4100-410.587	Prof Svcs - Animal Control	17,525	22,000	14,250	20,000	Includes annual Humane Society fees for consolidated services (\$10,000) and costs for administrating Trap, Neuter, and Release (TNR) program (\$10,000); program costs continue to increase for TNR administration.
01-4100-410.600	Utilities - Vehicle Fuel	96,948	115,000	88,000	90,000	Fuels for vehicle fleet and motorcycles, which have been sporadic due to inflationary pressures.
01-4100-410.670	Utilities - Telephone	31,552	30,000	30,000	30,000	Verizon charges for landline and cellular phones, including mobile hotspot devices.
01-4100-410.674	Utilities - Wireless Modem Cards	8,175	8,000	7,750	8,000	Cellular charges for in-car wireless modem access (15 units).
01-4100-410.900	Capital - Vehicle Purchases	100,545	66,710	94,000	91,000	2024 includes upfits for four replacement <u>leased</u> vehicles, and outright purchase and upfit of Tahoe due to emergency vehicle replacement need. 2025 includes upfit for four replacement <u>leased</u> vehicles, equipment for two reserve vehicle upfits (\$26,046), cargo upfit for UTV (\$5,000), and five push/PIT bumpers for trial to reduce maintenance/insurance costs (\$9,443).

LOWER PAXTON TOWNSHIP

Proposed 2025 Budget

Police Department

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01-4100-410.910	Capital - Equipment Purchases	15,985	-	2,388	17,782	2024 includes data collector attachment for electronic message boards acquired. 2025 includes radio for Co-Responder (\$8,182; <i>Federal grant funded</i>) and microphone/push-to-talk device/battery replacements for various staff.
01-4100-410.912	Capital - Specialized Gear	27,750	3,200	3,169	19,000	2024 includes confiscated cell phone charging locker. 2025 includes replacing refrigerated evidence locker (\$13,000) and new radar/speed detection portable sign (\$4,000).
01-4100-471.800	Debt - Principal - Vehicle Capital Leases	93,071	142,345	138,820	152,944	16 current vehicle leases , plus first-year principal on four new vehicles leases (\$50,000 estimated acquisition value per vehicle; all replacement vehicles). <i>Spending, once fleet all under lease, will be approx. \$400,000 total (30 vehicles).</i>
01-4100-471.801	Debt - Principal - Equipment Capital Leases	149,341	65,536	65,536	43,034	Includes lease payments for police taser replacements (2nd of five years) and 11 in-car Mobile Data Terminals (final); <i>2023 included expedited payoff of body/car camera lease through County gaming grant .</i>
01-4100-472.800	Debt - Interest - Vehicle Capital Leases	2,876	8,054	8,053	11,795	Interest portions of above capital vehicle leases.
01-4100-472.801	Debt - Interest - Equipment Capital Leases	5,885	334	577	11,295	Interest portions of above capital equipment leases.
01-4110-411.338	Supp & Admin - Fire Marshall & Canine	1,415	1,500	1,500	1,500	Memberships, training, and minor supplies for Fire Marshall role, including costs for canine Rudy.
01-4110-411.550	Prof Svcs - Foreign Fire Relief Payment	352,468	350,000	357,698	350,000	Allocation of State-levied tax on foreign fire insurance company gross premiums passed-through to local volunteer fire agency.
01-4110-412.552	Prof Svcs - EMS Contribution	100,000	100,000	100,000	100,000	Annual contribution to South Central EMS to support EMS service availability to Township residents and visitors.
TOTAL POLICE DEPARTMENT EXPENDITURES		\$ 8,678,977	\$ 8,690,474	\$ 8,531,286	\$ 9,202,773	

<u>Change in Revenues/Expenditures Statistics</u>	<u>2024 Budget vs. 2025 Budget</u>	<u>Percentage Change</u>	<u>2024 Projected vs. 2025 Budget</u>	<u>Percentage Change</u>
Increase (Decrease) in Expenditures	\$ 512,299	5.89%	\$ 671,487	7.87%

<u>Contractual/Discretionary Expenditures Statistics</u>	<u>2025 Budget</u>	<u>2024 Budget vs. 2025 Budget</u>	<u>Percentage Change</u>	<u>2024 Projected vs. 2025 Budget</u>
Budget Expenditures -- Contractual (Personnel)	\$ 7,468,460	\$ 248,125	3.27%	\$ 292,903
Budget Expenditures -- Discretionary	\$ 1,734,313	\$ 264,174	23.77%	\$ 378,584